

The gate review

Format: read the board, then decide • Time: 10 minutes • You are the reviewer • Answer in the chat

Recap. Before engineering builds, the P1 gate checks that the mandatory set is complete, every triggered conditional artefact is present, and each is signed off. A blank autonomy line or a bar with no sample size fails on sight.

1Mandatory set complete?
all five produced and filled

2Conditional triggers covered?
every triggered artefact present

3Each artefact signed off?
one accountable name per row

4Anything that fails on sight?
a blank autonomy line, a bar with no sample

The gate is four checks. A fail names the one artefact to finish, it does not send the whole thing back.

The situation

You chair the P1 gate for SkyWays. A product owner brings the **Auto-Refund agent**: when a booking is cancelled, it reads the booking, decides the refund the passenger is owed using a model, and issues it. It can refund up to \$200 without a person. It never touches a partner airline. The PM says it is ready to build and wants your sign-off today.

Here is exactly what they produced. Read every row before you decide.

P1 GATE REVIEW		Auto-Refund agent · what the PM brought to the gate		produced and complete	produced but incomplete	not produced
M	Problem brief	DONE	Reduce agent-handled refunds; 9,000/mo at \$9 each			
M	Agent spec	PARTIAL	Job, trigger, actions listed. Boundary field left blank			
M	Autonomy line	MISSING	No level written for any action			
M	Acceptance bar	PARTIAL	"90% accurate" written, no slice, no sample size			
M	Tool contract	DONE	Refund tool: reads booking, issues refund, \$200 cap, logs			
C	Statistical acceptance plan	MISSING	Output is a model score, so this is triggered			
C	Open-decisions log	DONE	One open item: partial-refund policy unconfirmed			
C	Autonomy spec	MISSING	The agent acts on a model decision, so triggered			

A1. What is your gate decision?

- ☐ a Pass. The mandatory set is mostly there and the rest can follow during build
- ☐ b Hold. Name the artefacts to finish first, then re-gate
- ☐ c Reject and send the whole set back to be redone
- ☐ d Pass on condition the PM verbally confirms the missing pieces

A2. Which produced artefact fails the gate on sight, even though something was written?

- ☐ e The problem brief, because the numbers are rough
- ☐ f The acceptance bar, because “90%” has no slice and no sample size
- ☐ g The tool contract, because \$200 is too low a cap
- ☐ h The open-decisions log, because one item is still unconfirmed

A3. The PM argues the missing autonomy line is “obvious, it just issues refunds.” What do you tell them?

- ☐ i Agreed, it is obvious, waive that one
- ☐ j The refund action is irreversible and moves money, so its level must be written, not assumed
- ☐ k Autonomy lines are the architect's job, not theirs
- ☐ l It only matters after launch, so it can wait for P2

A4. Which two conditional artefacts are triggered here but missing? (pick two)

- ☐ m Statistical acceptance plan
- ☐ n Registry entry
- ☐ o Autonomy spec
- ☐ p Rollback runbook

How to answer. Type all four with the letters you choose, for example A1 - a A2 - e A3 - i A4 - mn .